Customized SCI Cover Letters for Top 3 Target Q1 Journals

This document provides three ready-to-use Cover Letters tailored for (A) *Journal of Systems and Software (JSS)*, (B) *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management (IEEE TEM)*, and (C) *International Journal of Project Management (IJPM)*.

Option A: Journal of Systems and Software (Elsevier, SCI Q1)

To: The Editors-in-Chief, *Journal of Systems and Software*
Subject: Original Research Submission — *"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"*

Dear Editors-in-Chief,

Please find enclosed our original research manuscript entitled **"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"** for consideration in the *Journal of Systems and Software*.

Following the Design Science Research (DSR) paradigm, this study designs, formalizes, and empirically evaluates a four-layer governance architecture (*Agentic Work Lab* and *PublishOps CrossCast*, comprising **27,095 LOC** of production Python source across **123 modules** and **37,155 LOC** of automated tests across **126 test modules / 2,737 unit tests**). Across **N = 69** operational checkpoints, **N = 55** channel releases, **N = 30** SHA-256 verified video versions (2.21 GB), and **5 publishing platforms**, we prove that deterministic stage-gate invariants and idempotent `UNKNOWN`-latching state machines eliminate unauthorized writes and prevent duplicate releases during the post-submission confirmation window (which consumes **92.32%** of browser-mediated command latency).

Alongside the **21-page Main Manuscript**, we submit a **150-page Online Supplementary Material** compendium (Appendices A–H) containing formal proofs, complete datasets, and all 2,737 test identifiers. This manuscript is original and not under consideration elsewhere.

Sincerely,
HuaiCheng Sheng
Agentic Work Lab, Hangzhou Chengxin Holding Group Co., Ltd., Hangzhou, Zhejiang, China
Email: `ZackSheng@gmail.com` | ORCID: `0009-0003-2900-6377`

Option B: IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management (IEEE, SCI/SSCI Q1)

To: The Editor-in-Chief, *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*
Subject: Manuscript Submission — *"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"*

Dear Editor-in-Chief,

We respectfully submit our original manuscript entitled **"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"** for review in *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*.

Bridging Stage-Gate project control theory (Cooper, 1990; Bianchi et al., 2022) with fault-tolerant distributed release engineering, this Design Science study demonstrates how engineering managers can govern heterogeneous AI workflows (GPT/Codex, Claude, DeepSeek) via deterministic scheduling predicates (Algorithm 1), cryptographic plan-hash locks (Theorem A.3), idempotent receipt state machines (Algorithm 2), and non-parametric epistemic audit gates (Algorithm 3; Mann–Whitney $U = 65.5$, $p = 0.0012$). The submission comprises a **21-page Main Manuscript** and a **150-page Online Supplementary Material** compendium.

Sincerely,
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Option C: International Journal of Project Management (Elsevier, SSCI/SCI Q1)

To: The Editor-in-Chief, *International Journal of Project Management*
Subject: Manuscript Submission — *"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"*

Dear Editor-in-Chief,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript **"Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations"** for consideration in the *International Journal of Project Management*.

Responding to recent calls in project management scholarship on governing human–AI agency (Holzmann et al., 2022; Müller et al., 2024; Raisch & Krakowski, 2021), this study operationalizes Stage-Gate project governance into four computational invariants and validates them across $N = 69$ multi-agent handoff events, $N = 55$ publication records, and 5 platforms. Full empirical ledgers are provided in the accompanying **150-page Online Supplementary Material**.

Sincerely,
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